

PTH 8215: Patient Client Management IV



Department of Physical Therapy

Summer 2026 (10 weeks)

Mode of Delivery: In person

Mondays and Wednesdays: 12:30-2:45 (lecture/tutorial sessions)

Tuesdays and Thursdays: 12:30-2:30 (lab)

Course Information:

Semester: Summer

Credit Hours: 5 (3 lecture/2 lab)

Semester Contact Hours: 85

Weekly Contact Hours: 8.5 (4.5 lecture, 4 lab)

Instructors:

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Pre Requisites: Pathophysiology & Pharmacology I, Dynamic Systems II, Movement Systems, Exercise Prescription & Nutrition, Patient/Client Management III, Integrated Clinical III

Co Requisites: Pathophysiology & pharmacology II, Integrated Clinical IV

Course Description

Patient / Client Management IV is a problem-based course with tutorial and laboratory sessions and continues to develop depth and problem solving. This course specifically adds evaluation and interventions for neurological specific pathologies, movement systems, exercise, nutrition and the highest level of the hierarchy of adaptation to consideration of intervention effects.

Student Learning Outcomes

1. Implement appropriate PT interventions for patients with neurological conditions, consistent with legal and ethical practice, in alignment with the APTA core values, team-based approach, JEDI, and EBP. (7D1-11)

2. Implement appropriate teaching methods commensurate with the needs of the learner. (7D12)
3. Promote one's own career, the profession, and healthcare in general, with respect to the administration of PT for neurologically involved patients (7D14-15)
4. Perform screen and obtain a history, for neurologically involved patients along with other sources of information to determine whether patients/clients need further examination or consultation by a physical therapist or referral to another health care professional (7D16-17)
5. Select and perform physical therapy tests and measures typically used for patients with neurological diagnoses and identify factors that influence their use based on patients age; diagnosis and health status to assess patients / clients with primary neurological conditions and secondary musculoskeletal conditions including Aerobic capacity, Anthropometric Characteristics, Assistive Technology, Balance, Self-Care, Cranial and Peripheral Nerve Integrity, Environmental Factors, Gait, Integumentary Integrity, Mental Functions, Mobility, Motor Function, Muscle Performance, Neuromotor Development and Sensory Processing, Pain, Posture, Range of Motion, Reflex Integrity, and Sensory Integrity. (7D19)
6. Evaluate data from the examination (history; health record; systems review; and tests and measures), identify components and their interactions of the International Classification of Function (ICF) to describe a patient's/client's impairments; activity and participation limitations and determine a diagnosis that guides future patient/client management for patients with neurological conditions. (7D20-22)
7. Determine goals and expected outcomes within available resources (including applicable payment sources) and specify expected length of time to achieve the goals and outcomes for patients with neurological conditions. (7D23)
8. Develop a safe and effective plan of care, in collaboration with appropriate stakeholders, explain, communicate and supervise appropriately those components of the plan of care that will be directed to the physical therapist assistant (PTA) based on the needs of the patient/client; (b) the role; education; and training of the PTA; (c) competence of the individual PTA; (d) jurisdictional law; (e) practice guidelines policies; and (f) facility policies. (7D24-25, 29)
9. Create a discontinuation of episode of care plan that optimizes success for the patient in moving along the continuum of care. (7D26)
10. Competently perform physical therapy interventions to achieve patient/client goals and outcomes. Interventions include: Assistive Technology: Prescription; Application; and; as appropriate; Fabrication or Modification, Biophysical Agents, Functional Training in Self-Care and in Domestic; Education; Work; Community; Social; and Civic Life, Integumentary Repair and Protection, Manual Therapy Techniques (including mobilization/manipulation thrust and non-thrust techniques), Motor Function Training (balance; gait; etc.), Patient/Client education, Therapeutic Exercise. (7D27)
11. Manage, monitor and adjust the delivery of the plan of care that is consistent with professional obligations; inter professional collaborations; and administrative policies and procedures of the practice environment. (7D28, 30)
12. Assess patient outcomes; including the use of appropriate standardized tests and measures that address impairments; functional status and participation. (7D31)

13. Complete accurate documentation that follows guidelines and specific documentation formats required by state practice acts; the practice setting; and other regulatory agencies for patients with neurological conditions. (7D32)
14. Describe the necessary considerations and training for responding effectively to patient/client and environmental emergencies in one's practice setting. (7D33)
15. Describe case management and the provision of physical therapy services for patients with neurological conditions that address primary, secondary and tertiary prevention; health promotion; and wellness to individuals; groups; and communities. (7D34, 36)
16. Assess and document safety risks of patients and the healthcare provider and design and implement strategies to improve safety in the healthcare setting as an individual and as a member of the interprofessional healthcare team. (7D37)

Required Materials: (AccessPhysio)

O'Sullivan SB, Schmitz TJ, Fulk G. Physical Rehabilitation. FA Davis. Latest Edition available in Access Physiotherapy.

O'Sullivan SB, Schmitz TJ. Improving Functional Outcomes in Physical Rehabilitation. FA Davis. Latest Edition available in Access Physiotherapy.

Fell DW, Lunnen KY, Rauk RP. Lifespan Neurorehabilitation. FA Davis. Latest Edition available in Access Physiotherapy.

Subscription to PhysioU required for this course, we will be using several videos from this resource throughout the course.

Description of teaching methods and learning experiences

Lecture, class discussion, case tutorial sessions, role plays, videos and other guided learning activities, experiential activities, hands-on learning activities, laboratory, various assignments and presentations.

Assignments and Activities

Final Exam (Cumulative – both Abrupt Onset and Progressive content):	35%
Mid-term Exam	25%
Assignments (cases, etc.)	
Abrupt Onset	5%
Progressive	5%
Rounds presentations	5%
Final Practical Exam	25%

Cases

Throughout the semester, students will be presented with paper cases, macro cases that may span years in the patient's life and include transitions from setting to setting, and micro cases

used to illustrate one or two points. The cases in PCM IV specifically focus on evaluation and interventions for neurologic-specific pathologies.

Rounds

Students will prepare and present assigned patient cases during a clinical “rounds” presentation as scheduled. A power point template for the presentation is provided to the students and all students will be responsible for the information covered in the presentation on the course final examination.

Exams

The exams will be delivered in person but via Canvas and may contain a combination of test question types (Multiple choice, short answer, matching, T/F, essay, etc.). There will be a cumulative final exam for this course. Contact the PSU Helpdesk (535-2929) for assistance with technical issues.

Practical Exam

For specific content for PCM IV practical exam (cases, schedule, format) refer to the “Practical Exam” module on the Canvas site. Note, content for the practical exam is an integration of material from PCM IV, along with a cumulative expectation from all prior courses.

Practical Exam Failure

Practical exam grades are incorporated into the PCM course grades. Successfully completing the practical exam requires a grade of at least 73%. A grade of less than 73% results in a PCM course grade of an F. There are elements of a practical exam that are considered safety concerns, and failure in an element related to a safety concern results in failure of the practical exam. If a student fails the practical exam, they can repeat one time and achieve a maximal grade of 73% (on the entire practical). Prior to the repeat exam the student must meet with the PCM course coordinate to review the exam results, develop a remediation plan and make plans for the repeat practical. The repeat exam may be a subset of the full practical exam, including only the elements that clearly led to failure.

Student Evaluation/Grading

A	94.0 – 100
A-	90.0 – 93.9
B+	87.0 – 89.9
B	83.0 – 86.9
B-	80.0 – 82.9
C+	77.0 – 79.9
C	73.0 – 76.9
F	below 73.0

Students are reminded that continuation in the program necessitates achieving an overall grade point average of 3.0 (B) or better. Grades below 2.0 (C) are not acceptable or counted toward the DPT degree. No more than 10 credits below 3.0 may be counted toward the DPT degree

(grades of B-, C+, or C). Make-up examinations will be given only in specific cases of absence (documented absences). Circumstances that may warrant an absence should be discussed with the instructor before the scheduled time of the exam. Failure to notify the instructor as stated may result in a zero for the exam.

Doctor of Physical Therapy Student Handbook: Students are reminded that more detailed information on program policies, including the appropriate and ethical use of Artificial Intelligence (AI), can be found in the Plymouth State University Doctor of Physical Therapy Student Handbook.

Professional Conduct: Students are reminded of the program expectation that they follow Professional Conduct, see the Student Handbook, Professional Conduct and Reasonable Professional Expectations for the process of handling violations, remediation and consequences.

Cell Phones: Cell phone use (including texting) is prohibited in class. Also, please respect your classmates by turning your phone to vibrate prior to class start time. Do not turn phones off as the University uses texts to relate emergency information.

Graduate Academic Policies: The DPT Program is a selective admissions cohort-structured program. Some Graduate Academic Policies may not be relevant to the program. Students should refer to the Doctor of Physical Therapy Program Handbook for specific information about Scheduling, Capstones, and Internships. The sections on Grading System and Academic Standing Policy do apply to DPT students: <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/graduate-academic-policies/>

Fair Grading Policy: Fair and equitable grading reflects values to which all members of the Plymouth State community commit themselves. Grades are used to assess the relative extent to which students achieve course objectives in all for-credit courses at PSU. Academic freedom allows instructors to determine course objectives within the bounds of established curricula, and the means by which a student's mastery of those objectives will be evaluated; and evaluate the quality of work on individual exams or assignments. Information can be found at <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under Fair Grading.

Student Support: Student Support Foundation (SSF) provides short-term emergency financial assistance and long-term student support. For more information, see: <https://campus.plymouth.edu/student-support-foundation/>
Student Support Foundation also runs a food pantry, located in Belknap Hall. To learn more about SSF or access the food pantry, either via open hours or a private appointment, contact the SSF advisor, at psu-ssf@plymouth.edu.

Academic Dishonesty: Cheating and plagiarism are very serious forms of academic dishonesty. Any use of unauthorized assistance on exams, papers, homework assignments, or other course work constitutes cheating. Knowingly providing assistance during an exam or allowing other students to copy one's work is also a serious form of academic dishonesty. Plagiarism consists

of submitting written work that has been developed wholly or partially by someone else. Submitting written work in which the ideas of others have been duplicated or even paraphrased without proper reference to the author is also a form of plagiarism. Also considered plagiarism is the acquisition of term papers or other assignments from another source and subsequent presentation of these materials as the student's own work. In addition, students may not use papers in more than one course without the permission of both instructors.

Any student suspected of academic dishonesty will be reported to the Program Director immediately. A full description of academic integrity, violations and procedures when a violation to academic integrity in a course is suspected can be found at: <https://coursecatalog.plymouth.edu/university-policies-procedures/> under Academic Integrity.

Attendance Policy: Attendance is expected for all class sessions. Students are ultimately responsible for their attendance; however faculty will assess students' Professional Expectations based, in part, on their attendance (See Student Evaluation/Grading). Students who miss class for any reason are responsible for the information and work missed. Students should speak with the professor before missing the scheduled class when able.

Campus Accessibility Policy: Plymouth State University is committed to providing students with documented disabilities equal access to all university programs and facilities. If you think you have a disability requiring accommodations, you should immediately contact Campus Accessibility Services (CAS) in Speare210 (535-3300) to determine whether you are eligible for such accommodations. Academic accommodations will only be considered for students who have registered with CAS. If you have a Letter of Accommodation for this course from CAS, please provide the instructor with that information privately so that you and the instructor can review those accommodations: <https://campus.plymouth.edu/accessibility-services/>

LibGuide for Physical Therapy:

The Libguide for Physical Therapy is an information sharing platform created through a collaboration between the library and the DPT faculty that presents relevant resources to support students in the Physical Therapy program. Examples of information you will find include tutorials to better understand citing sources in APA and AMA style, resources on how to avoid plagiarism, quick access to relevant databases and interlibrary loan as well as a contact link to the program's assigned librarian. To view the DPT Program Libguide go to <https://library.plymouth.edu/physical-therapy>.

Diversity and Inclusivity Statement:

I consider this classroom to be a place where you will be treated with respect, and I welcome individuals of all ages, backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, genders, gender identities, gender expressions, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual orientations, ability - and other visible

and non-visible differences. All members of this class are expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming and inclusive environment for every other member of the class. See this web page for the Plymouth State University IDEA Center Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access <https://www.plymouth.edu/idea-center>

Tentative Class Schedule:

This class will consist of in-person lecture/discussion/case tutorial and laboratory/hands-on learning sessions and asynchronous materials and activities posted on Canvas. In general, this class will meet for approximately 4.5 hours per week of “lecture/discussion” based content and 4 hours per week of “hands-on/laboratory-based” content. The content will flex based on the contents of each of the modules. See detailed schedule in Canvas.

Weekly schedule overview:

Section 1: M/T: Abrupt Onset and W/Th: Progressive

Section 2: M/T: Progressive and W/Th: Abrupt Onset

Week/Dates	Progressive (specific content may change from below throughout course)	Abrupt Onset (specific Macro/Micro content may change from below throughout course)	Special topics/ considerations
1: June 1-4	Macro MS-1; Overview of progressive neurological conditions	Macro A1: TBI	Movement Systems diagnoses - neuro
2: June 8-11	Macro MS-2, ALS-1; ALS overview; Selection of clinical examination measures	Macro B1: SCI Macro A2	Stages of Motor control
3: June 15-18	Macro MS-3, ALS-2, PD-1; Overview of Parkinson Disease; Examination of patient with PD	Macro A3 Macro B2	Framework for Rehabilitation with progressive conditions
4: June 22-25	Macro MS-4, ALS-3, PD-2; Discussion of movement disorders	Macro C1: CVA Micro 1: L3 ASIA C SCI	
5: June 29 - July 2	Midterm Exam; Intro to community wheelchair mobility skills	Macro B3	Mid-term Exam
6: July 6-9	Macro ALS-4, PD-3; PPS and GBS overview	Macro C2	Brunnstrom stages
7: July 13-16	Macro PD-4; ALS video	Macro C3 Micro 2: BPPV	
8: July 20-23	Considerations for disease progression; Hospice care	Micro 3: Vestibular hypofunction	
9: July 27-30	Student Rounds Presentations	Considerations for progression: SCI	
10: Aug 3-7	Final Written and Practical Exams	Final Exam	Cumulative Final Practical Exam